arms to the Afghan rebels through the Pakistani government. While the exact quantum of Saudi financial and military assistance was not known, it seemed that Afghan insurgents were procuring light infantry weapons clandestinely from the countries of the Gulf and Middle East. Egypt had opened centres in Pakistan to facilitate Afghan insurgents and small arms were airlifted from Egypt to Pakistan on a regular basis. Interestingly, these arms had been procured from the Soviet Union by the Egyptian government. Afghan insurgents were fighting the Soviets with weapons made in Moscow!

The R&AW operatives worried that the intense indoctrination, the huge cache of arms and the vast army of terrorists in Pakistan and Afghanistan could be a security nightmare for India when the war in Afghanistan ended. According to Ashfaq, the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan not only brought a threat close to India's border but also initiated the process of producing more terrorists than ever. The JIC stated that there was no possibility for a proper lasting peace in the strife-torn region. The report said:

The Soviet appears willing to maintain a prolonged military presence, despite adverse international reaction and believe that a policy based on attrition, force, steady indoctrination and incentives would eventually achieve their objectives. The Soviets have been trying to change some aspects of Afghan society on the Soviet model e.g. military, government, party cadres, and economy. If things become difficult for the Soviets, there are other options open to it including that of crushing the insurgency with a vastly enhanced military strength, and if necessary to use the Balochistan card at an appropriate time, should Pakistan go beyond limits of tolerance. There appears to be no likelihood of the withdrawal of Soviet troops unless a pro-